Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Ltd

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A robust capital plan in the works?

Investment Overview

Refocusing on growth engines. OCBC launched a new strategy focusing on the next frontier of growth, which includes deepening core market franchise across its twin hubs Singapore and Hong Kong as well as refreshed strategies within ASEAN domestic markets. Management guiding for stable to improving ROE, driven by a stronger focus on higher-returning businesses while maintaining cost discipline with CIR at low to mid-40%. OCBC is the only Singapore bank to guide for stable to improving income in FY26F, driven by double-digit growth in non-interest income, while confident of a mid-single digit loan growth.

Potential special dividends on the cards. Management reaffirmed a 50% dividend payout ratio. As management guides for stable to higher total income, potential for higher DPS comes via higher EPS. Should there be a revision in dividend policy to further enhance shareholder returns, this could be a rerating catalyst for OCBC. Management has indicated preference to pay out unutilised share buyback amounts by end FY26F in the form of special dividends.

Downside risks from asset quality cushioned by high non-performing loan (NPL) coverage ratio. We remain watchful of asset quality risks in a slower global growth environment amidst concerns of accelerating Fed cuts on top of the weak commercial real estate (CRE) sector. NPL coverage ratio continues to be high at 151%.

Maintain BUY, TP SGD23. Our TP is based on the Gordon Growth Model (13% ROE, 3% growth, and 9% cost of equity). Our TP represents a ~1.5x FY27F, 2 S.D. above OCBC's historical 12-year average P/BV (one-year forward). We revised our earnings through FY26-27F by 3-5%, on higher non-interest income assumption.

Risks

Deteriorating asset quality. Higher-than-expected NPLs, high inflationary pressure, and recessionary risks could unwind expectations for credit cost and NPL declines, thus posing risks to earnings.

Forecasts and Valuation

FY Mar (SGDmn)	FY2023(A)	FY2024(A)	FY2025(A)	FY2026(F)	FY2027(F)
Pre-prov. Profit	8,181	8,672	8,711	9,038	9,522
Net Profit	7,021	7,587	7,422	7,778	8,224
Net Pft (Pre Ex.)	7,021	7,587	7,422	7,778	8,224
Net Pft Gth (Pre-ex) (%)	27.1	8.1	(2.2)	4.8	5.7
EPS (S cts)	156.2	168.7	164.9	172.8	182.7
EPS Pre Ex. (S cts)	156.2	168.7	164.9	172.8	182.7
EPS Gth Pre Ex (%)	nm	nm	nm	nm	5.7
Diluted EPS (S cts)	156.2	168.6	164.9	172.8	182.7
PE Pre Ex. (x)	13.7	12.7	13.0	12.4	11.7
Net DPS (S cts)	83.1	101.7	99.6	101.9	96.8
Dividend Yield (%)	3.9	4.7	4.6	4.8	4.5
ROAE Pre Ex. (%)	13.3	13.4	12.2	12.1	12.2
ROAE (%)	13.3	13.4	12.2	12.1	12.2
ROA (%)	1.3	1.3	1.2	1.1	1.1
BV Per Share (S cts)	1,205	1,318	1,387	1,459	1,545
P/Book Value (x)	1.8	1.6	1.5	1.5	1.4

Source: DBS

BUY

Last Traded Price: SGD21.43
Price Target 12-mth: SGD23.00

Analyst

Rui Wen Lim | groupresearch@dbs.com

What's New

- New growth strategy ahead to drive ROE sequentially
- Preference for special dividends over buyback, opening room for special dividends from unutilised share buyback program by FY26F
- Maintain BUY, TP S$23

Key Financial Data (FY Dec)

Bloomberg Ticker	OCBC SP
Sector	Financials
Market Cap (USDbn)	76.0
3m Avg. Daily Val (USDmn)	72.7
Major Shareholders	(%)
Selat Pte Ltd	14.5
Free Float (%)	85.5

Closing Price as of 24/02/2026

Source: Twelve Data, DBS, Visible Alpha, S&P Cap IQ Pro

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Ltd Share Price



Source: Twelve Data

Quarterly / Interim Income Statement (SGD, mn)

FY Mar	4Q2024	3Q2025	4Q2025	% chg y/y	% chg q/q
Net Interest Income	2,455.0	2,226.0	2,296.0	(6.5)	3.1
Non-Interest Income	961.0	1,570.0	1,320.0	37.4	(15.9)
Operating Income	3,416.0	3,796.0	3,616.0	5.9	(4.7)
Operating Expenses	(1,565.0)	(1,524.0)	(1,564.0)	(0.1)	2.6
Pre-provision Profit	1,851.0	2,272.0	2,052.0	10.9	(9.7)
Provisions	(208.0)	(139.0)	(200.0)	(3.8)	43.9
Associates	245.0	279.0	261.0	6.5	(6.5)
Exceptionals	0.00	0.00	0.00	-	-
Pre-tax Profit	1,888.0	2,412.0	2,113.0	11.9	(12.4)
Taxation	(201.0)	(434.0)	(300.0)	49.3	(30.9)
Minority Interests	0.00	0.00	0.00	-	-
Preference Dividend	0.00	0.00	0.00	-	-
Net Profit	1,687.0	1,978.0	1,813.0	7.5	(8.3)
Net Profit before Except.	1,687.0	1,978.0	1,813.0	7.5	(8.3)
Net Interest Income Gth (%)	0.9	(2.5)	3.1		
Net Profit Gth bef Except (%)	(14.5)	8.92	(8.34)		
NIM (%)	2.2	2.1	2.2		
NPL Ratio (%)	0.9	0.9	0.00		
Loan-to-Deposit (%)	80.7	78.6	0.00		
Cost-to-Income (%)	45.7	40.0	43.1		
Total CAR (%)	19.7	19.4	0.00		

Source: DBS

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What's New

25 Feb 2026

Takeaways from OCBC briefing

- New growth strategy ahead to drive ROE sequentially
- Preference for special dividends over buyback, opening room for special dividends from unutilised share buyback program by FY26F
- Maintain BUY, TP S$23

Next frontier of growth. Under the new strategy, OCBC will also pivot to focus on ASEAN domestic market as well, expand affluent customer base by leveraging Great Eastern Malaysia ecosystem à customers are equivalent to half of Singapore's population, representing a large base to work on. GEH will also focus on UHW individuals base and look to grow business extensively in next few years, organic and inorganic options, and work more closely with other parts of the bank. Management shared that they will invest going forward but is likely to space out investments as they do not want to deviate from 40-45% CIR.

Dividends and capital ahead, preference for special dividends over buyback. Management believes that new strategy is focused on growth and with growth strategy, this can translate to higher DPS on higher EPS. As excess capital for growth, management is more comfortable to stick with dividend policy of 50% payout ratio, will complete current capital exercise by 2026. CEO has indicated his preference to pay unutilised share buyback amounts as special dividends by FY2026. The current unutilised share buyback amounts to S$780m, representing 22% of original target buyback amount completed thus far, which translates to 17 Scts/share. Management reaffirmed that they want to take opportunity to acquire things when/if downturn occurs. On GEH's front, full year dividends has increased from 45 Scts/share to 55 Scts/share for FY25 while GEH CEO reaffirmed a progressive dividend policy, as GEH will progressively pay up to 50% payout ratio and will not go backwards – management is committed that shareholders will get at least same amount of dividends in FY26F. OCBC management believes that chapter on GEH privatisation has closed and is not looking to acquire more GEH shares in foreseeable future.

Confidence in asset quality. Two real estate accounts in Greater China contributed to new NPA formation during the quarter. MEV update was taken to reflect improved Singapore GDP forecast and management believes credit costs will remain benign at 20-25bps for the year and hope to do better than that as OCBC is well-positioned to navigate risk spots including Hong Kong/ Greater China real estate portfolio. OCBC has no exposure to US private credit and have been circumspect about private credit in Asia, with no exposure in the book currently.

Non-interest income. Net new money of +S$6bn this quarter continues to be strong, with year-to-date net new money at +S$27bn, +30% y/y. Investment-to-AUM ratio continues to be >60%. Management sees non-interest income growth at double-digit through FY26F, driven by wealth growth amongst others.

Net interest income. Current assumptions based on average 1.4% 3M SORA, hence there will be downside risk to revenue expectations (slight to moderate decline in NII) if 3M SORA ends below 1.4%.

Loan growth continues to be robust. Loan growth in constant currency terms at +9% y/y, continues to be higher than system growth – broad-based across sectors, of which sustainable financing loans now +13% y/y, accounts for 17% of group loans. OCBC continues to be confident in delivering mid-single digit loan growth through FY26F.

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Principal Share Price Drivers

Asset quality

We estimated that OCBC has ~S$700m in management overlays in general provisions. NPL coverage ratio of 150% allows for buffer in light of heightened macroeconomic uncertainties.

Banks' share prices typically trade below book value during a credit cycle as market prices in impairments to its loan book. Hence, NPL ratio and credit costs are critical factors to OCBC's share price in the current cycle.

Despite heightened macroeconomic uncertainties, management has stated FY26F guidance for credit costs to be in the range of ~20-25bps.

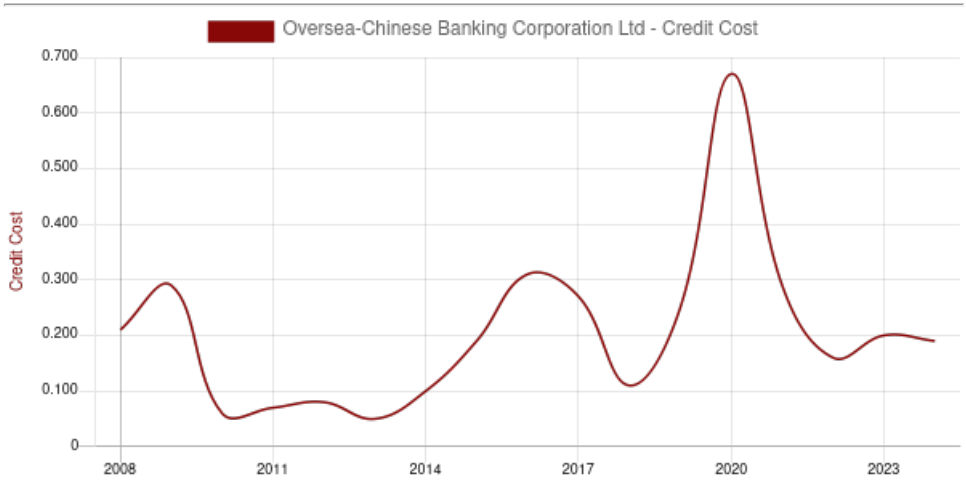
We continue to keep watch on sectors with potential weaknesses, for instance Hong Kong CRE where OCBC has exposure to. OCBC has been actively engaging with clients to manage and reduce exposures, particularly within the medium-sized commercial segment. The remaining CRE exposure is largely to well-rated, larger corporate clients, which should translate to a minimal impact on overall NPL.

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Ltd - Share Price vs. NPL Ratio



Source: 12DATA, Datastore

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Ltd - Credit Cost



Source: Datastore

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Return on Equity

We believe OCBC's ROE has bottomed out in FY20 and ROE should consequentially improve from thereon. Under OCBC's new strategy focusing on driving sustainable growth via various parts of the bank, management is guiding for stable to improving ROE over the next few years, while keeping cost discipline with CIR between 40-45%.

We believe P/B is the way the market values the stock, reflecting the capital intensive nature of the business which ultimately generates return on its liabilities. OCBC's P/B has been improving over the years on the back of continued cost efficiencies, higher profitability and better capital management.

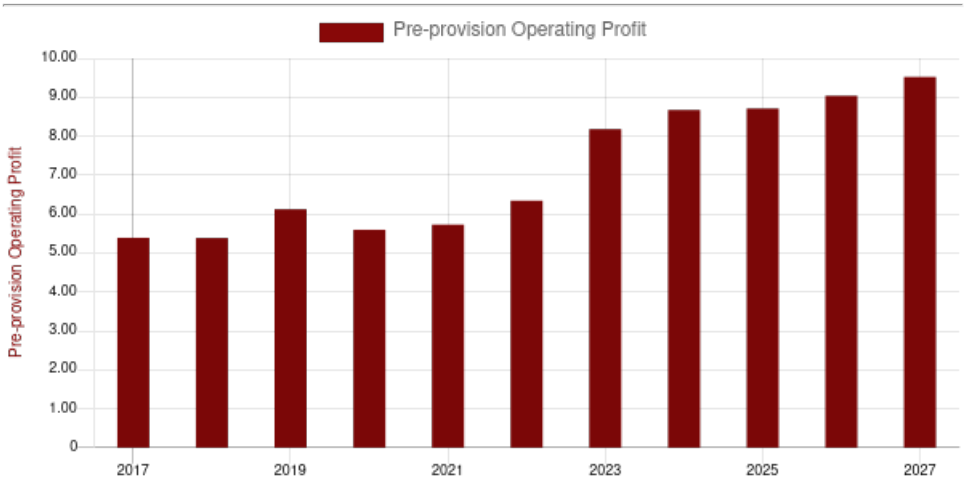
We believe one of the drivers to better ROE, aside from profitability which may be limited in a declining rates environment, is clarity on plans of capital management going forward.

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Ltd - Return on Equity vs. Price to Book



Source: OCBC

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Ltd - Pre-provision Operating Profit



Net Interest Margin

Historically, interest rates correlate to OCBC's share price. While OCBC has held NIM up largely through 2023, NIM expansion cycle is over in face of lower benchmark rates. We see NIMs pressure to continue into FY26F though there is room for further optimising funding costs.

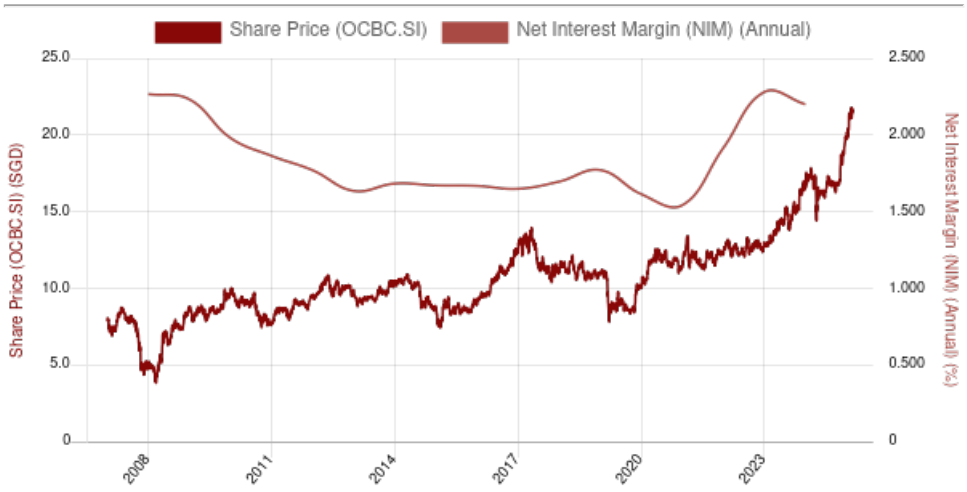
Interest rates are linked to loan pricing and hence net interest margin (NIM), which in turn drives earnings and share price.

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Historically, NIM correlates to OCBC's share price.

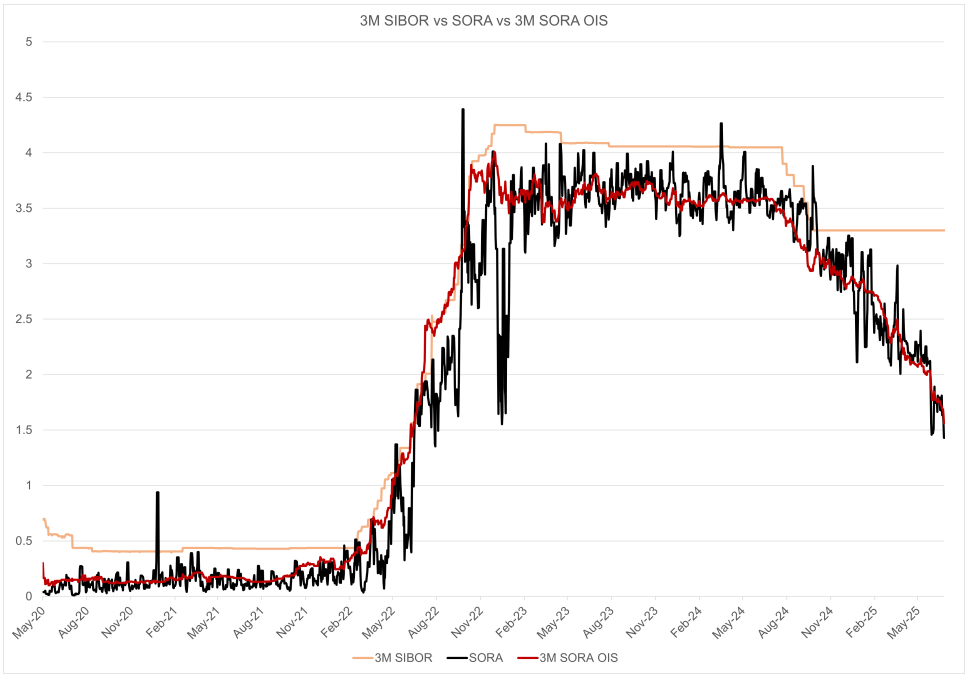
NIM sensitivity: Every 1bps change in interest rate over OCBC's four major currencies will impact net interest margins by 11bps on an annualised basis as of 3Q25.

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Ltd - Net Interest Margin (NIM) (Annual) vs. Share Price (OCBC.SI)



Source: OCBC

3M SORA, 3M SIBOR and SORA



Capital management/ Dividends

Acquisitions and divestments may drive or weigh on OCBC's share price. OCBC management has discontinued the scrip dividend discount of 10% in 4Q20, having attained highest CET1 ratio amongst peers which still continues to be the case. Higher dividend payout ratio is a potential share price catalyst.

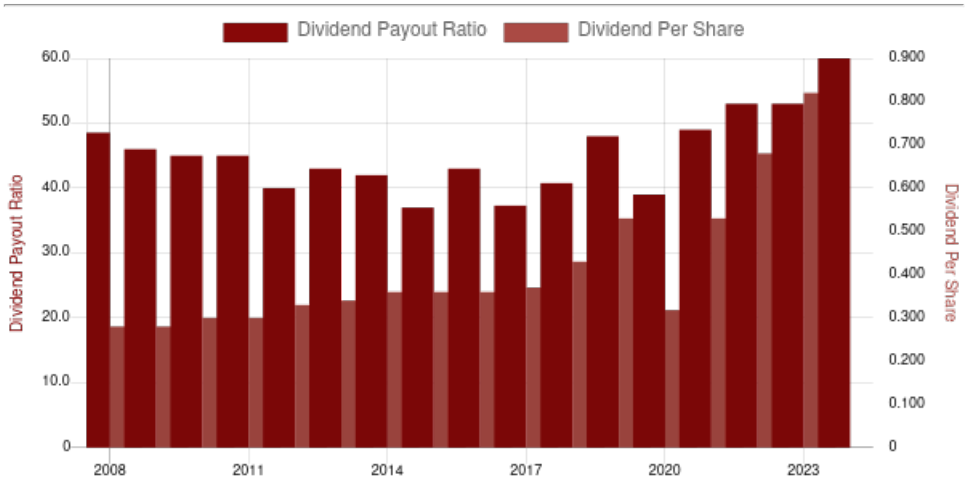
OCBC has been shoring up capital in view of potential market opportunities (i.e. acquisitions). During FY24, OCBC completed the acquisition of 100% of PT Bank Commonwealth and made a voluntary offer of SGD25.60 per share to acquire the remaining 11.56% stake in GEH, aiming to delist its insurance arm.To support

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its proposal to delist GEH, OCBC has made a new exit offer at SGD30.15 per share for the remaining 6.28% GEH shares it does not own on 6 June 2025. OCBC has confirmed that this exit offer price is final and has no plans to make another offer in the foreseeable future.

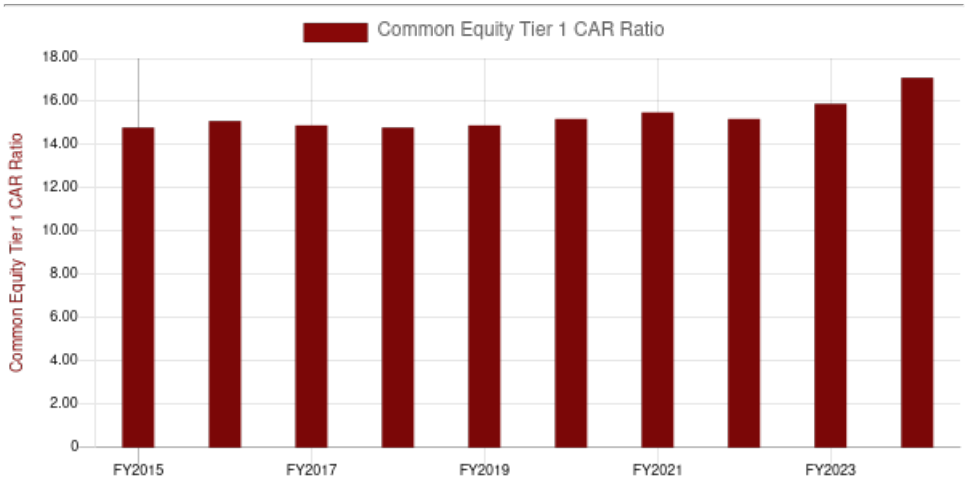
As part of the capital distribution strategy, management has announced a SGD2.5bn capital distribution over two years. The package consists of special dividends for FY24 and FY25 set at a 10% payout of annual net profit and share buybacks over a two-year period. OCBC is targeting for a total dividend payout ratio of 60% annually for FY24 and FY25, comprising its target ordinary dividend payout ratio of 50% and a 10% from the special dividend payout.

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Ltd - Dividend Payout Ratio vs. Dividend Per Share



Source: OCBC

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Ltd - Common Equity Tier 1 CAR Ratio



Loans Growth

Loan growth, which also drives net interest income, continues to be differentiated for OCBC. OCBC has achieved higher-than-market loan growth at c.7% for FY25 (+9% y/y in constant currency terms) and continues to target for mid-single digit loan growth in FY26F.

During 2025, OCBC saw a notable increase in loan to the transportation, storage, and communications sectors, which is in line with the group's strategy to capture new economy and fast-growing industries.

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Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Ltd - Total Loan Growth vs. Share Price



Source: OCBC

Singapore Industry Loan Growth (DBU+ACU Loans)



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Company profile

The OCBC Bank group of businesses (OCBC) comprises a family of companies owned by Singapore's longest-established local bank.

Income breakdown (as at FY24)

In FY24, non-interest income comprised 33% of total group income as OCBC continues to grow its non-interest income. Great Eastern Holdings contributed 12% of FY24's group net profit.

Net fees & commissions	42%
Dividends & rental income	3%
Trading income	33%
Net gains from investment securities and others	4%
Life & general insurance	19%

Geography breakdown (as at FY24)

	Customer loans	Operating Profit
Singapore	42%	56%
Greater China	23%	20%
Malaysia	8%	12%
Indonesia	6%	6%
Rest of the world	21%	6%

Balance sheet

Keep watch on asset quality. OCBC's NPL ratio stood at 0.9% as at 4Q25. We remain watchful of asset quality risks in a slower global growth environment amidst concerns of accelerating Fed cuts on top of the weak commercial real estate (CRE) sector. NPL coverage ratio continues to be high at 151%.

Strong capital ratios. Capital ratios remained strong with the CET1 and total CAR at 16.9%/19.4% respectively in 4Q25.

Environment, Social, Governance

OCBC has developed a Sustainability Framework, reinforcing the bank's vision for sustainability in FY18. OCBC continues to implement its sustainability framework and monitors the progress via its KPIs. In 2024, over 200 green, social, and sustainability-linked loans were extended to wholesale banking clients, with sustainability advisory provided in more than 140 of these transactions. These efforts contributed to a SGD15 bn increase in the committed sustainable finance portfolio, bringing the total to SGD71 bn.

Valuation summaries

Maintain BUY, TP SGD23. Our TP is based on the Gordon Growth Model (13% ROE, 3% growth, and 9% cost of equity). Our TP represents a ~1.5x FY27F, 2 S.D. above OCBC's historical 12-year average P/BV (one-year forward). We revised our earnings through FY26-27F by 3-5%, on higher non-interest income assumption.

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Income Statement (SGD, mn)

FY Dec	FY2023(A)	FY2024(A)	FY2025(A)	FY2026(F)	FY2027(F)
Net Interest Income	9,645	9,755	9,150	9,133	9,507
Non-Interest Income	3,862	4,718	5,464	5,984	6,337
Operating Income	**13,507**	**14,473**	**14,614**	**15,117**	**15,843**
Operating Expenses	(5,326)	(5,801)	(5,903)	(6,079)	(6,322)
Pre-provision Profit	**8,181**	**8,672**	**8,711**	**9,038**	**9,522**
Provisions	(733.0)	(690.0)	(665.0)	(662.0)	(707.0)
Associates	953.0	994.0	1,077	1,185	1,303
Exceptionals	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Pre-tax Profit	**8,401**	**8,976**	**9,123**	**9,561**	**10,118**
Taxation	(1,236)	(1,228)	(1,563)	(1,638)	(1,740)
Minority Interests	(144.0)	(161.0)	(138.0)	(145.0)	(153.0)
Preference Dividend	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Net Profit	**7,021**	**7,587**	**7,422**	**7,778**	**8,224**
Net Profit bef Except	7,021	7,587	7,422	7,778	8,224
Net Interest Income Gth (%)	25.5	1.14	(6.20)	(0.19)	4.10
Net Profit Gth bef Except (%)	27.1	8.06	(2.17)	4.80	5.73
Spread (%)	2.10	2.00	1.76	1.68	1.71
Net Interest Margin (%)	2.28	2.20	1.91	1.77	1.77
Cost-to-Income Ratio (%)	35.4	36.5	38.0	37.8	37.5
Net Int. Inc / Opg Inc. (%)	71.4	67.4	62.6	60.4	60.0
Non-Int. Inc / Opg inc. (%)	28.6	32.6	37.4	39.6	40.0
Fee Inc / Opg Income (%)	13.4	13.6	16.5	18.1	19.5
Oth Non-Int Inc / Opg Inc (%)	15.2	19.0	20.9	21.5	20.5
ROAE Pre Ex. (%)	13.3	13.4	12.2	12.1	12.2
ROAE (%)	13.3	13.4	12.2	12.1	12.2

Source: DBS

Quarterly / Interim Income Statement (SGD, mn)

FY Dec	4Q2024	1Q2025	2Q2025	3Q2025	4Q2025
Net Interest Income	2,455.0	2,345.0	2,283.0	2,226.0	2,296.0
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Operating Expenses	(1,565.0)	(1,420.0)	(1,395.0)	(1,524.0)	(1,564.0)
Pre-provision Profit	1,851.0	2,235.0	2,152.0	2,272.0	2,052.0
Provisions	(208.0)	(212.0)	(114.0)	(139.0)	(200.0)
Associates	245.0	274.0	263.0	279.0	261.0
Exceptionals	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Pre-tax Profit	1,888.0	2,297.0	2,301.0	2,412.0	2,113.0
Taxation	(201.0)	(414.0)	(485.0)	(434.0)	(300.0)
Minority Interests	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Preference Dividend	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Net Profit	1,687.0	1,883.0	1,816.0	1,978.0	1,813.0
Net Profit before Except.	1,687.0	1,883.0	1,816.0	1,978.0	1,813.0
Net Interest Income Gth (%)	0.9	(4.5)	(2.6)	(2.5)	3.1
Net Profit Gth bef Except (%)	(14.5)	11.6	(3.56)	8.92	(8.34)
NIM (%)	2.2	2.2	2.2	2.1	2.2
NPL Ratio (%)	0.9	0.9	0.9	0.9	0.00
Loan-to-Deposit (%)	80.7	78.9	78.7	78.6	0.00
Cost-to-Income (%)	45.7	38.7	39.2	40.0	43.1
Total CAR (%)	19.7	20.2	19.6	19.4	0.00

Source: DBS

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Balance Sheet (SGD, mn)

FY Dec	FY2023(A)	FY2024(A)	FY2025(A)	FY2026(F)	FY2027(F)
Cash/Bank Balance	34,286	34,599	30,756	36,575	38,403
Government Securities	45,630	44,685	66,404	69,060	71,823
Inter Bank Assets	38,051	42,407	37,942	43,659	45,402
Total Net Loans & Advs.	292,754	315,096	336,692	353,120	367,215
Investment	36,591	43,413	53,267	55,866	58,096
Associates	7,003	8,153	8,799	9,984	9,984
Fixed Assets	4,251	4,400	4,713	4,949	5,196
Goodwill	4,501	4,504	4,360	5,160	5,161
Other Assets	20,840	25,502	23,146	24,718	25,705
Life Ass Fund Inv Assets	97,517	102,291	109,609	115,089	120,844
Total Assets	**581,424**	**625,050**	**675,688**	**718,180**	**747,828**
Customer Deposits	363,770	390,687	428,286	456,125	478,931
Inter Bank Deposits	10,884	11,565	15,280	18,711	16,383
Debts/Borrowings	26,553	31,553	30,482	30,482	30,482
Other Liabilities	25,019	27,933	28,671	31,063	30,599
Life Ass Fund Liabs	99,644	102,932	109,399	114,869	120,612
Minorities	1,384	1,064	1,126	1,271	1,271
Shareholders' Funds	54,170	59,316	62,444	65,660	69,550
Total Liab& S/H's Funds	**581,424**	**625,050**	**675,688**	**718,180**	**747,828**

Source: DBS

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Target Price & Ratings History - Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Ltd (OCBC_SP_Equity)



#	Date of Report	Closing Price	12-m Target Price	Rating
1	27 Feb'25	17.21	17.60	HOLD
2	07 Apr'25	16.62	14.40	HOLD
3	04 Aug'25	16.79	15.80	HOLD
4	09 Nov'25	17.78	19.80	BUY
5	29 Jan'26	21.29	23.00	BUY

Source: DBS
Analyst: Rui Wen Lim

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BUY (>15% total return over the next 12 months for small caps, >10% for large caps)
HOLD (-10% to +15% total return over the next 12 months for small caps, -10% to +10% for large caps)
FULLY VALUED (negative total return, i.e., > -10% over the next 12 months)
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**Share price appreciation + dividends*

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